meanings depending on whether the negotiating states are nuclear haves or nuclear have–nots. Under these circumstances there can be either deterrence or compellance or coercive diplomacy. Deterrence comes into being if the parties involved in the negotiation are all nuclear haves. Then possession of nuclear arsenal will deter them from using the nukes. On the other hand if the other party does not possess nukes then that party may be compelled into doing certain things which the nuclear-haves might desire. But there is an unprecedented risk attached to this type of nuclear diplomacy and a crisis situation might escalate and reach the threshold of nuclear war as manifested during the Cuban Missile Crisis.

Public Diplomacy: This form of diplomacy which became popular in the US in the 1960s signifies engagement with the foreign public in the context of realising foreign policy objective. This assumes the form of people-to-people contact which involves the inclusion of academicians, NGOs, cultural groups, tourism, films, theatres, internet and blogging. The chief aim is to increase people-to-people contact and improve the image of a country abroad alongside the traditional mechanisms of diplomacy. This public-private partnership has immensely increased due to the improvement in communications, information exchanges and media and internet revolution. The USA, aptly uses public diplomacy to improve public relations and its image in other countries through the Voice of America, organization of academic exchanges (students and teachers), seminars, film shows and host of other activities. These activities are conducted by USIS in several countries. Educational exchange programmes in India are conducted through USIEF (United States-India Educational Foundation). However, for long, public diplomacy was seen as a euphemism for propaganda. Nevertheless, scholars and practitioners of public diplomacy have tried to overcome this parochial interpretation of the term and have embarked on policies that aim at enhancing people-to-people contact.